Nickolas Diaz

Martha Seney

Professional Experience Internship

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Internship Search Reflection Assignment: Learning from the Process

1. Process: What was your overall approach to finding an internship? How many positions did you apply to, and how did you select them? What resources (career center, networking, job boards, etc.) did you use?

My overall approach was mainly going on job boards and applying to summer internships for anything that was in my knowledge like IT, cybersecurity and software engineering. I used boards like Linkedln, handshake and google jobs. I would read the job description and tailor it directly to the job. For example a IT job would favor things like certifications and home labs while software engineering would favor coding projects.

2. Self - Assessment: How would you assess your resume and interview skills? What feedback did you receive, if any, and how did you use it?

The resume format I used was created in YAML which is a text language which can automatically create a pdf. All I had to do was modify my text file using this website. I think my strength is my resume. I had it reviewed by several people at the cybersecurity club and they did not have any problems with it. For my interview skills, I need more work. I failed 2 interviews and I learned that I need to be more expressive. I often say things that are too generic, instead I should include more personal statements. For example “I am a hard worker” is too generic but a story of how I saved a situation because of my hard work is much more impressive.

3. Barriers and Challenges: What obstacles did you encounter during your internship search? Were there external factors (timing, location, industry trends) that impacted your success?

I think the biggest barrier to my internship search is finding the right opportunity that can get me an interview with an employer. Applying online is not very effective in terms of getting more interviews. In addition going in person is also not very effective, it is hard to actually make connections with others. My personal experience is always the recruiter saying just apply online.

4. Mindset & Effort: How consistent was your effort through the search process? When did you start applying to internships? Did you stay motivated? What helped or hindered your motivation?

I was not very consistent with the search process, sometimes I am really motivated to apply but other times I am discouraged. My main motivation is being able to get a job within my field but my discouragement is the difficulty and competition within the tech industry. It is especially demotivating to hear how much work others have put into it and got no offers.

5. Learning and Growth: What have you learned about the internship process that you didn't know before? What would you do differently next time?

I did not know the effectiveness of making connections with the employer. A job application who does not know anyone is not going to be effective at all.

6. Moving Forward: How do you plan to stay proactive in gaining experience in your field? How will your internship hours this summer assist you in moving forward in your career aspirations?

I will continue to gain more skills to improve in the field. The 100 hour plan really motivated me on doing this, I will gain a precious knowledge in using the Cloud with my AWS certification. I will move forward and be more consistent with my applications.